PassFrame
TUITION

Market Day

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The square at dawn is grey and still,
then slowly, slowly starts to fill:
a cart, a crate, a canvas sheet,
the first stall clattering down the street.

By nine o'clock the air is thick
with cries of "Apples, ripe and quick!"
and "Fresh-cut flowers, buy a few!"
and bread still warm and steaming through.

A fiddler plays a merry tune,
a juggler spins beneath the noon,
and children dart from stall to stall
with coins held tight, not spent at all.

I buy a peach, as soft as silk,
and watch a farmer pour his milk,
and think how strange it is that here,
a square so grey can hold such cheer.

By dusk the stalls are folded flat,
the fiddler gone, and that is that —
the square falls quiet, grey once more,
till market day comes round once more.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. What is the square like at the very start of the poem?

2. Name two foods mentioned being sold at the market.

3. Underline the line that tells you children were excited but careful with their money.

4. Underline the simile that describes the peach.

5. What does "clattering" suggest about the sound of the first stall arriving?

6. True or false: the fiddler plays a sad, slow tune.

7. Why do you think the poet describes the square as "grey and still" both at the start and the end?

8. What two performers does the poet mention in the third verse?

9. In your own words, describe how the market changes from dawn to dusk.

10. What does the final line, "till market day comes round once more", suggest about the pattern of life in this town?

11. Why do you think the poet chose to end on the square falling quiet, rather than on the busy market scene?

12. Do you think the poet enjoys market day? Use evidence from the poem to explain your answer.